

BACKLINKO

THE GO-TO
GUIDEBOOK

WORKSHEET

The Go-To Guidebook

As you saw in the video, a Go-To Guidebook is a curated list of links to exceptional content.

(Important Note: If you didn't watch the video, this worksheet won't make any sense. So make sure to watch the video before you continue reading)

But unlike most “best of” posts, like “best posts about email marketing” or “10 helpful resources on dog training”, the architecture of the Go-To Guidebook is VERY strategic.

With that, let's break the process down, step-by-step.

1 Step #1: Brainstorm 5-10 Topics for Your Go-To Guidebook

Your first step is to brainstorm 5-10 topics for your Go-To Guidebook.

First, search for topics at Quora.com.

For example, let's say you run a site in the fitness niche. You'd search for keywords like “fitness”, “interval training” and “fat loss”.

List out topics that you find from Quora here:

QUORA TOPICS

You can also use a tool like Buzzsumo. Just enter a keyword and see what topics have already done well.

List out topics that you find from BuzzSumo here:

BUZZSUMO TOPICS

If you weren't able to find at least 5 topics in Quora and Buzzsumo, no worries. You can perform the same search in YouTube.

If a video has a ton of views, it's because people are interested in that topic.

List out topics that you find from YouTube here:

YOUTUBE TOPICS

2 Step #2: Choose a Topic From Your List

Now it's time to choose a topic from the list of topics that you put together in step #1.

How? Choose a topic that can be broken down into 7-10 subtopics.

Why 7-10?

If the topic is too broad, you won't be able to cover everything in only 10 subtopics.

If the topic is too narrow, you won't be able to break it up into 7 subtopics.

List 2-3 Go-To Guidebook topic options here:

TOPIC OPTIONS

Choose one from the list and move onto Step #3...

3 Step #3: Break Your Topic Down into 7-10 Subtopics

Now it's time to break your topic down into 7-10 subtopics. These subtopics will be the chapters for your Go-To Guidebook (more on that later).

Having trouble with your subtopics? Well, pretend that you just signed a contract to write a book on your topic. The first thing your publisher asks for is a table of contents for the book. What topics would you cover? What chapters would absolutely have to be there?

If you're not absolutely sure what to include, no worries. Just write down a bunch of sub topics that make up your larger topic. Then trim down any that don't seem like a good fit. They don't have to be perfect for your Go-To Guidebook to work.

List out your 7-10 subtopics here:

SUBTOPICS	

4

Step #4: Turn Your Subtopics Into Benefit-Rich Chapter Titles

OK, so you have your Go-To Guidebook topic and a list of 7-10 subtopics. Now it's time to dramatically boost the perceived value of your content.

How? By turning bland subtopic names into benefit-rich chapter titles.

Here are a few “plug and play” chapter titles:

How to _____ with _____

How _____ can get you _____

How to get more _____ from _____

Quick note: You don't need to turn 100% of your subtopics into benefit-rich chapters. For example, Chapter 5 in the link building guide I talked about in the video is simply “Grey and Black Hat Techniques”.

Write 7-10 chapter titles below.

CHAPTER TITLES	

5 Step #5: Add Links to 4-9 Excellent Resources in Each Chapter

Now it's time to add links to each chapter.

What content should you include here? Content that's valuable and on-topic. That's it.

No need to overthink things here. Just include content that will help people get to the outcome you described in your chapter title.

How can you find content to include? Just Google keywords that describe the chapter. And include quality content from the top 10-30 results. You can also search directly on popular blogs in your industry.

List the resources for each chapter here:

RESOURCES

6 Step #6: Create Your Go-To Guidebook

Now that you have your topic, chapters and links ready to go, it's time to create your Go-To Guidebook.

Let's break the process down, step-by-step.

1. Write Your Title

Because your Go-To Guidebook puts so much great content in one place, you want to position it as a “definitive” or “ultimate” guide.

Write your title here:

TITLE

Examples:

The Ultimate Guide to Accounting Software

Gluten Free Baking: The Definitive Guide

2. Craft Your Intro

Next, it's time for your intro.

Your intro should briefly introduce the topic you're covering and include some common challenges people tend to have with that topic.

Example:

“As you know, gluten free baking can be a confusing mess. There are dozens of different flours to sift through. And how do you know which are really gluten free? Well in this guide I'm going to give you all the tools you need to become a gluten free master chef.”

Write your intro in the field below:

INTRO

3. Complete Your Table of Contents

Next, you want a table of contents. This makes your content look more like a “book”, which boosts its perceived value.

Your table of contents needs:

- A subheader that repeats your Go-To Guidebook title or adds a different twist.
- A very brief description of the guide
- Page jump links to each chapter of your guide ([here's how to set these up](#))

Write out your table of contents here.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

4. Add your chapters to the guide.

Here's how to organize them:

Beginning: Basic and introductory topics

Middle: Detailed and advanced topics

End: Links to world class resources, case studies, tutorials etc.

List out your Go-To Guidebook chapters in order here:

CHAPTERS

Beginning

Middle

End

5. Create each chapter.

Next, you need to create each chapter.

Here's what to include in each one:

- Chapter number and title
- Brief (50-100 word) description of the subtopic
- Links to your resources (open in a new tab)

(At this point you probably want to copy your intro and table of content into Wordpress. It's much easier to write in Wordpress than in a PDF :-))

And once you finish that step, you're set.

So make sure to get started on your Go-To Guidebook today.

Talk soon,

Brian Dean